

striven with me, and spoken frequently to me and said: 'My brother, take to wife a sister of my two wives'; but I refuse to do as he has done. 9. I swear before thee, mother, that all the days of my life I will not take me a wife from the daughters of the seed of Canaan, and I will not act wickedly as my brother has done. 10. Fear not mother; be assured that I shall do thy will and walk in uprightness, and not corrupt my ways for ever." 11. And thereupon she lifted up her face to heaven and extended the fingers of her hands, and opened her mouth and blessed the Most High God, who had created the heaven and the earth, and she gave Him thanks and praise. 12. And she said: "Blessed be the Lord God, and may His holy name be blessed for ever and ever, who has given me Jacob as a pure son and a holy seed; for he is Thine, and Thine shall his seed be continually and throughout all the generations for evermore. 13. Bless him, O Lord, and place in my mouth the blessing of righteousness, that I may bless him." 14. And at that hour, when the spirit of righteousness descended into her mouth, she placed both her hands on the head of Jacob, and said:

15. "Blessed art thou, Lord of righteousness and God of the ages;

And may He bless thee beyond all the generations of men.

May He give thee, my son, the path of righteousness,

And reveal righteousness to thy seed.

16. And may He make thy sons many during thy life,

And may they arise according to the number of the months of the year.

*Abraham . . . gave me many commands.* Cf. xx. 4, xxxix. 6.

8. *These two and twenty years.* This agrees with the statement of Esau's age in Gen. xxvi. 34, where he is said to have been forty when he married. Esau was now sixty-three.

14. *Spirit of righteousness* (or "truth") = τὸ πνεῦμα τῆς ἀληθείας. Cf. John xiv. 17, xv. 26, xvi. 13. So *abd.* Cf. xxxi. 12. *c* reads "Holy Spirit." The latter is Jewish also: cf. Is. lxiii. 10, 11 "His holy Spirit" (רוח קדש). With the idea conveyed by